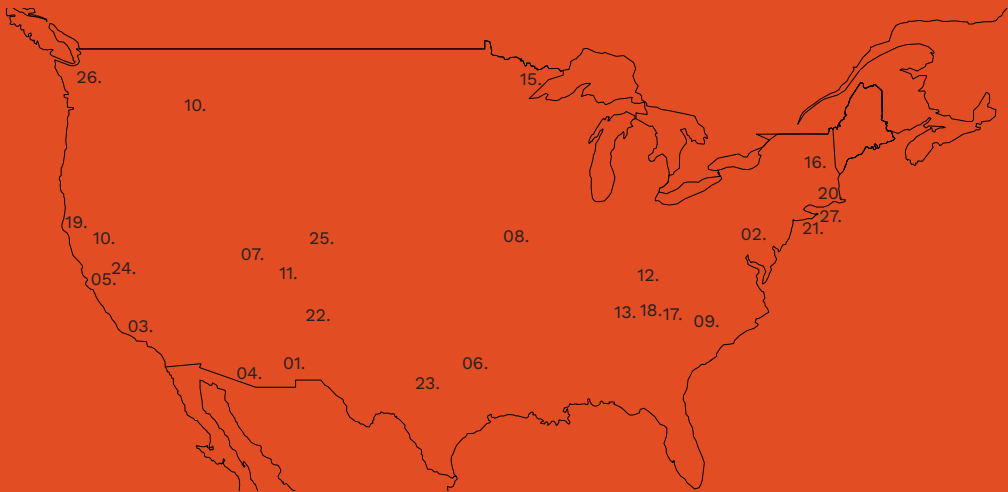


EDUCATIONAL OPPORTUNITIES AVAILABLE IN THE UNITED STATES

Do not despair eager American natural builder. We have created a brief list of the many options available to continue your journey.



WORKSHOPS AND INTERNSHIPS

01. Adobe In Action

A.I.A. and the EarthUSA conference they host are resources for earth building, with hands-on and online courses.

02. Build Naturally

Sigi Koko has been consistently leading (and selling out) workshops on straw and natural plaster for decades.

03. CalEarth

Learn from the originals about super-adobe. They offer workshops and longer-term apprenticeships.

04. The Canelo Project

Bill and Athena Steen are among the pioneers of the natural building revival.

05. California Straw Building Association

Spring and summer in California belong to CASBA. Workshops abound.

06. Cob Hill Natural Building School

Attend comprehensive workshops with discounts for veterans, military, and first responders.

07. Community Rebuilds

Build affordable housing and learn about straw, earthen plaster, and carpentry in Moab, Utah.

08. Dancing Rabbit Eco Village

Dancing Rabbit offers some cob workshops and online coursework on natural building.

09. Mud Dauber School of Natural Building

This school teaches how to build with cob, straw, plaster, or hempcrete.

10. Muddy Hands

Amanda Fischer does hands-on workshops in northern California for straw and natural plaster.

11. Strawbale.com

Timbo & Dainella are always running workshops in Montana and Colorado.

12. The Year of Mud

They offer workshops on plastering, timber framing, dry stack, and other natural techniques.

13. This Cob House

Alex Sumerall's project draws people to workshops from around the country.

ONLINE RESOURCES

ACTeco

ACTeco is a European collection of organizations that offer online courses in earth and straw building.

Architects Climate Action Network

ACAN is putting in the work, with regular webinars available around the world, public working groups for discussions on climate issues and much more.

Bauhaus Erde

BE is putting out some of the best writing and research on regenerative building. It's an excellent resource on large scale development.

BuildingGreen Campus Wide Access

If you're enrolled in higher education, you can likely access the articles on BuildingGreen.com, and if not, get your school to sign up.

Carbon Leadership Forum
CLF has local chapters all over the US, where it's easy to meet like-minded people working on low-carbon building solutions and they have a LOT of research to share on their website.

MEP 2040

The mechanical, electrical, and plumbing specialists equivalent of the AIA2030, which also has some good online resources on their website, particularly about refrigerants.

The Nito Project

The YouTube channel by Benito and Kalin Steen, children of the legendary Bill and Athena, is a source of inspiration with their simple, beautiful demonstrations of natural building methods.

OneClickAcademy

Free online courses from One Click LCA, each catered to aspects of life cycle assessment and the different stakeholders in construction.

STEP certification

A broadly accepted European straw-building certificate that can be completed online with multiple European straw organizations. (or hands-on in Europe if you're over there)

CRAFT SCHOOLS

15. North House Folk School

Traditional craft school teaching straw, timber, and all sorts of handcraft technique

16. Yestermorrow

Perhaps the most well-known craft school in the US in natural building circles for their natural building certificate, and wide spectrum of courses from carpentry to tadelakt.

17. Wild Abundance

A permaculture and carpentry school nestled in the Appalachian mountains.

CONFERENCES

AIA Conference on Architecture

Organized by the American Institute of Architects, this conference steers toward the centrists but always includes good sustainability presentations.

The West Coast Natural Building Conference

Organized annually by CASBA, this conference collects builders and architects from around the country for the information and the community.

Earth USA

The annual conference for advancing earthen-building techniques in the US.

EcoBuild

A conference dedicated to sustainable construction, materials, and energy efficiency.

Greenbuild International Conference and Expo

An annual event for architects focused on

sustainable building practices, innovative products, technologies, and strategies for creating environmentally friendly spaces.

Living Future Conference

Organized by the International Living Future Institute, this event focuses on regenerative design and the Living Building Challenge.

The Rocky Mountain Natural Building Conference

Every 2 years NaBA collects an exciting group of builders from the mountain west and beyond for lively discussion and excellent presentations.

HIGHER EDUCATION

18. Appalachian State University

App State's Appropriate Technology program, founded in 1978, is now part of their Sustainable Technology and the Built Environment department.

19. Cal Poly Humboldt

Known for its focus on environmental sciences, this university offers programs in a number of sustainable building practices.

20. Harvard University

Harvard's GSD is one of the leading research hubs for sustainable building methods right now.

21. Parsons School of Design

The Healthier Materials and Sustainable Building course, along with the Healthy Materials Lab provide an excellent option for people who want to make conventional construction less bad.

22. Santa Fe Community College

The Adobe Construction pathway is a good course for academic and hands-on earth-building.

23. University of Texas Austin

UT Austin offers research-oriented graduate programs in sustainable design.

24. University of California Berkeley

There are all sorts of sustainable design efforts going on at Berkeley, notably the Energy, Civil Infrastructure, and Climate program headed by Arpad Horvath.

25. University of Colorado at Boulder

The Environmental Engineering Program at CU Boulder is a well-respected engineering program that focuses heavily on life cycle analysis and sustainability with a thought leader in this arena Sherri Cook.

26. University of Washington

UW has been at the forefront of sustainability research for years. It is the home of the Carbon Leadership Forum, and the Life Cycle Lab, a research group in the College of Built Environment led by Kate Simonen.

27. Yale

The joint degree program of architecture and environmental management has led to a thriving field of research particularly around wood building.